TIFAC

TECHNOLOGY INFORMATION, FORECASTING AND ASSESSMENT COUNCIL (TIFAC)

(An autonomous body under Department of Science and Technology)
Government of India

Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav

HARNESSING TECH FOR SELF-RELIANCE

TIFAC, India's technology think tank, has made numerous scientific interventions in the service of the nation, bringing about marked improvements in socio-economic sectors in the true spirit of Aatmanirbhar Bharat

Technology is at the heart of the development and progress of a nation. But merely foreseeing, identifying, evaluating and charting out technological processes for different sectors is not enough until action plans are initiated to make changes at the ground level with a focus on livelihood improvement and boosting up economy. This is where the role of Technology Information, Forecasting and Assessment Council (TIFAC) assumes extraordinary significance in India.

Playing a critical role in the S&T ecosystem, TIFAC has made significant impact on society by driving successful innovations in various areas of national importance. In the words of Dr VK Saraswat, Former Chairman- TIFAC Governing Council, "In the emerging scenario, TIFAC has to play a catalytic role in bringing all players of the innovation chain on one platform to facilitate technology identification forecasting and its evaluation and translation for commercialisation to achieve the goal of "Atmanirbhar Bharat". Concurs Anil Kakodkar, former Chairman, TIFAC, "TIFAC has served the nation well as a technology think tank in exploring ideas, their relevance, importance and potential in the national context and producing reports to inform policy making."

HOW THE JOURNEY BEGAN...

The Government of India's Technology Policy Statement 1983 highlighted the need for undertaking technology forecasting and assessment studies on a systematic and continuing basis. Subsequently, on the recommendations of Scientific Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (SAC-PM), TIFAC was instituted as an autonomous registered society under the Department of Science and Technology in February, 1988.



> "TIFAC has been doing a commendable job in the technology foresight domain under the S&T Ministry, helping the Government to take informed decisions about drawing policies and future investments."
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> *— Dr Srivari Chandrasekhar, Secretary, Department of Science & Technology*

This organisation has had the rare privilege of being chaired by stalwarts and visionaries of S& T domain including Late Dr V Krishnamurthy, Late Dr APJ Abdul Kalam, Dr R Chidambaram, Dr Anil Kakodkar, Dr VK Saraswat and currently Prof Devang Khakkar.

SUCCESSIVE STRIDES

Since its inception, TIFAC has shaped itself into a vibrant knowledge network with a variety of activities. Its mandate is to assess the state-of-art technology and set directions for indigenous technological developments in India demonstrating models of technology through synergistic relationships. Based on TIFAC's initial foresight studies, the Government made large investments in addressing the problems of fly ash, promotion of advanced composites and quality improvement of sugar. It led to the setting up of three missions: Fly Ash Mission, Advanced Composite Mission and Sugar Technology Mission.

Inspired by former President of India, Bharat Ratna Dr A P J Abdul Kalam, the then chairman of TIFAC Governing Council (1993-2001), the Technology Vision 2020 document was the first of its kind that laid down the technology path for India to emerge as a developed nation by 2020. Subsequently, TIFAC was entrusted with the assessment of forecasted technologies as mission mode programme for important socio-economic sectors, including agriculture, agro-food processing, healthcare, upgradation of road construction machinery, upgradation of textile, upgradation of science & engineering colleges and other targeted areas.

LOOKING AHEAD

To continue with the visioning exercise, TIFAC prepared Technology Vision 2035 document which was dedicated to the nation by Hon'ble Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi Ji in 2016.
As part of this exercise, a number of formidable challenges have been identified in achieving the vision of ensuring the security, enhancing the prosperity, and strengthening the identity of every Indian. Apart from drawing the technology path and ten grand challenges, TIFAC had also flagged the country's capabilities and constraints in charting the future roadmap in the vision document.

In fact, TIFAC plays a crucial role towards flagging, alerting and planning Government response to fast changing technological scenario and rapidly evolving geo-political relations and their impact on Indian economy.